

Agarwal stated, “We try to stick with software that has strong community support, and if we happen to require software that doesn’t have a strong community behind it, we commit our internal resources for its upkeep.”

Why open source for startups?

Jugnoo was co-founded by Agarwal and his IIT course-mate Samar Singla in October 2014. Both the co-founders are not new to the startup culture as they launched mobility solutions provider Click Labs before this new venture. The prior experience helped the team choose the relevant open source technologies.

“Open source software provides easy and speedy installation and use, results in fewer audit headaches as you scale up, costs less and overall, helps startups a lot when you often do not have dedicated bureaucratic IT teams,” Agarwal stated.

Cost-effectiveness is a major attraction

One of the factors behind choosing open source solutions over some proprietary options is certainly their cost-effectiveness. In the case of Jugnoo, Agarwal revealed that the entire infrastructure costs were just one-third the cost of completely proprietary infrastructure, thanks to open source deployments.

When asked about how security is ensured through open source deployments, Agarwal said that his team deploys only those solutions that are already being used by a large number of organisations across the globe. But if the company really needs to use some less-known open source projects, it tests its functionality in a sandbox environment first.

Jugnoo currently has a presence in 35 cities and around 12,000 auto-rickshaw drivers in India are using its app to earn their livelihood. The startup is not looking to grab the market of taxi aggregators like Uber and Ola. Instead, it continues its focus on auto-rickshaws in the country by using open source solutions.



Chinmay Agarwal, co-founder and CTO of Jugnoo, at the Jugnoo server room

“We focus on making our auto-rickshaw drivers the core revenue builders by engaging them in the services we provide, be it Dodo or Fatafat. We aim at growing to be the market leader in the auto-rickshaw space and to capture up to 20 per cent of the total market. We see ourselves in another 65 towns by the end of this financial year,” Singla said.

Jugnoo’s success with open source technologies is very encouraging for organisations thinking of moving away from proprietary solutions. Open source has been fruitful for many Indian entrepreneurs like Agarwal and Singla, who are aiming to grow bigger through some efficient deployments. 

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OSFY Magazine Attractions During 2016-17

MONTH	THEME
March 2016	Open source Databases
April 2016	Backup and Data Storage
May 2016	Web Development
June 2016	Open Source Firewall and Network security
July 2016	Mobile App Development
August 2016	Network Monitoring
September 2016	Open Source Programming Languages
October 2016	Cloud Special
November 2016	Open Source on Windows
December 2016	Machine Learning
January 2017	Virtualisation (containers)
February 2017	Top 10 of Everything